DIVERSE Learning Platform – Privacy Policy

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This privacy policy explains how personal data is processed on the DIVERSE learning platform (the "platform"), the shared online learning environment of the GreenTech4Transformation (GT4T) project and the partner universities of the DIVERSE European University Alliance. It provides the information required by Articles 13 and 14 of the EU General Data Protection Regulation (Regulation (EU) 2016/679, "GDPR").

1. Who is responsible for your data

- **Data controller:** Istanbul Beykent University, which operates the platform within the GT4T project.
- **Contact for all privacy questions and requests:** beykent-gt4t@beykent.edu.tr
- **Partner universities:** each partner university approves and manages the accounts of its own students and staff on the platform (for example new registrations and password resets) and can also be contacted about its own users.

2. Which personal data we process

- **Account data:** username, first and last name, e-mail address, the partner university you belong to, student number (if asked at registration), password (stored only in hashed form), preferred language and, if you add them, city, country, profile picture and profile description.
- **Learning data:** the courses you are enrolled in, your activity in courses (pages visited, completed activities), submissions, quiz answers, grades and feedback, forum posts and messages you send to other users.
- **Live session data:** when you join a live session (BigBlueButton), your name and role are passed to the video conferencing service; your audio, video, screen sharing and chat are transmitted to the participants during the session. Live sessions are currently not recorded.
- **AI course assistant data:** if you use the AI course assistant, your questions and the related course content are sent to an external AI service (currently Google Gemini) to generate an answer. You choose how long your conversations are kept.
- **Technical data:** IP address, browser and device information, date and time of access and system logs, needed to run and protect the platform.
- **Cookies:** the platform uses only cookies that are strictly necessary for it to work (for example the session cookie that keeps you logged in, and a cookie that remembers your username if you choose so). No advertising, analytics or tracking cookies are used.

3. Purposes and legal bases

- **Providing the platform and its courses** (your account, enrolments, learning activities, live sessions, grades): Article 6(1)(b) GDPR – necessary for the service you registered for – and, for courses offered by public universities, Article 6(1)(e) GDPR – a task carried out in the public interest (education).
- **Approving registrations and keeping each partner's users separate and secure** (account approval by your partner university, login checks, logs, protection against misuse): Article 6(1)(f) GDPR – our legitimate interest in a secure platform.
- **Reporting on the GT4T project to the funding body** in aggregated, anonymous form (for example the number of participants per partner): Article 6(1)(f) GDPR and, where required, Article 6(1)(c) GDPR.
- **AI course assistant:** only if you choose to use it; Article 6(1)(a) GDPR – your consent. You can withdraw it at any time by no longer using the assistant and deleting your conversations.
- **Complying with legal obligations** (for example answering lawful requests of authorities): Article 6(1)(c) GDPR.

We do not sell your data and we do not use it for advertising. We do not make decisions with legal or similarly significant effects about you based solely on automated processing (Article 22 GDPR).

4. Who receives your data

- **Within the platform:** the teachers and managers of your courses (your activity, submissions and grades in their courses), the managers of your own partner university (your account), other participants of your courses (your name, profile picture and what you post in shared areas) and the platform administrators.
- **Processors acting on our behalf:**
  - the hosting provider of the platform's server (TürkTicaret.net, Istanbul, Türkiye);
  - the provider of the video conferencing service used for live sessions;
  - Google, for the AI course assistant, only when you use it.
- **Public authorities,** only where the law requires it.

5. Transfers outside the European Economic Area

The platform's server is located in Türkiye, a country for which the European Commission has not adopted an adequacy decision. Using the platform therefore involves a transfer of your personal data outside the EEA, and the AI course assistant and the video conferencing service may involve processing in further countries. These transfers are based on appropriate safeguards under Article 46 GDPR, in particular the European Commission's standard contractual clauses, or, where such safeguards are not available, on the conditions of Article 49 GDPR. You can request information about the safeguards and a copy of them at the contact address above.

6. How long we keep your data

- **Account and learning data:** as long as your account is active and, after that, only as long as needed for the purposes above, at the latest until the end of the GT4T project and its reporting obligations. The data is then deleted or anonymised.
- **System logs:** deleted automatically after the retention period configured on the platform.
- **AI assistant conversations:** for the period you choose in the assistant; you can delete them at any time.
- **Live sessions:** not recorded; the chat of a session is not kept after the session ends.

7. Your rights

Under the GDPR you have the right to:

- access your personal data and receive a copy of it (Article 15);
- have inaccurate data corrected (Article 16);
- have your data erased (Article 17);
- restrict the processing of your data (Article 18);
- receive your data in a structured, commonly used and machine-readable format and have it transmitted to another controller (Article 20);
- object at any time to processing based on our legitimate interests or on a task in the public interest (Article 21);
- withdraw your consent at any time, without affecting the lawfulness of processing before the withdrawal (Article 7(3)).

To exercise your rights, write to beykent-gt4t@beykent.edu.tr. We answer within one month; this period can be extended by two further months for complex requests, in which case we will tell you. You also have the right to lodge a complaint with a data protection supervisory authority, in particular in the EU member state where you live, work or where an alleged infringement took place (Article 77).

8. Is providing your data required?

The account data marked as required at registration is necessary to create your account and use the platform; without it you cannot register. Everything else (profile picture, description, use of the AI course assistant) is optional.

9. Security

Access to the platform is protected by encrypted connections (HTTPS), personal passwords and role-based permissions. Each partner university's users are kept separate: an account can only log in on its own partner's login page, and managers see only their own users.

10. Changes to this policy

We may update this policy when the platform or the law changes. The current version is always available on the login page. If the changes are significant, we will inform you on the platform.